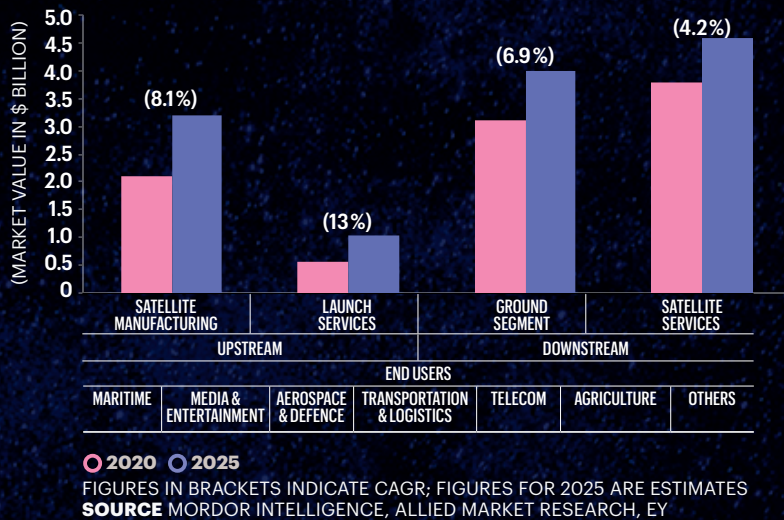


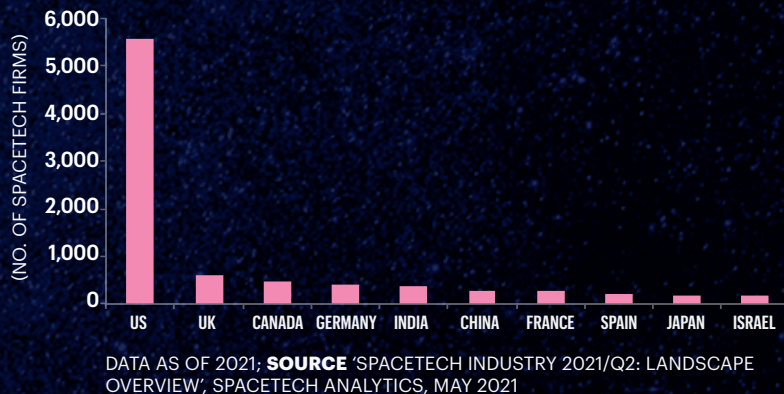
# REACHING FOR THE SKIES

Private participation in launch vehicles, satellites, applications and ground services needs to go up as the market expands



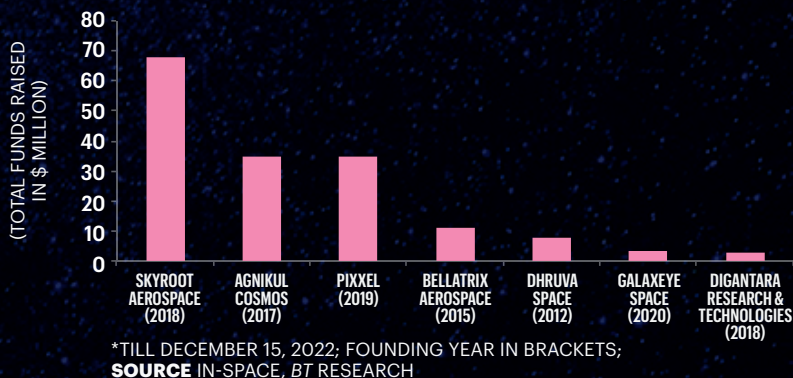
## TAKING OFF

India has the highest number of spacetechnology companies, which includes start-ups, in Asia



## MAKING IT COUNT

In 2022\*, leading Indian spacetechnology start-ups raised more than \$110 million in funding



Uttarakhand to track satellites and space debris in lower earth orbit (LEO) and geosynchronous earth orbit (GEO), to offer global space traffic management operations.

## THE SECRET SAUCE

But what's powering this transformation? It's the work done by ISRO and the Indian National Space Promotion and Authorisation Centre (IN-SPACe), the nodal agency for promoting and regulating private players in the sector. They have achieved a first-of-its-kind alignment between a government body and the private sector. ISRO, since its inception in 1969, has developed a network of 400-plus vendors—including Hindustan Aeronautics Ltd, Larsen & Toubro, Godrej & Boyce, Alpha Design Technologies and Centum Electronics—that specialise in tech development, manufacturing and supply of components. The push for start-ups in the space sector is part of ISRO's vision to expand private players' participation in the sector by enabling companies that can develop end-to-end solutions to grow.

Some of the most important developments took place in 2020 when the commercial space sector was opened up for private players. This was followed by the creation of IN-SPACe, and the release of draft policies on remote sensing and satellite communications. "The space sector had to be opened up because we had reached a point of inflection where we needed to encourage people in the private space to contribute to the domains where there was a business opportunity. ISRO has been doing that as a government entity, but the sector's commercial potential could not be exploited in that model," says Sreedhara Panicker Somanath, Chairperson, ISRO, and Secretary, Department of Space.

IN-SPACe Chairperson Pawan Goenka says that he is always on the lookout for developing new syn-